



State of the City 2025

Meeting Metadata	Details
Video Recording	https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=X8hVBlwRcYc
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Municipal Meeting Report: State of the City Address

1. Pre-Meeting Hearings & Committee Work Sessions

(No statutory public hearing or committee session was held immediately prior to this event.)

2. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order & Spoken Details:** **00:01:21** The event commenced with a welcome and invocation for the City of Muncie's State of the City address, presided over by Mayor Dan Ridenour.
- **Attendance & Key Participants:**
 - **Presiding Officer:** Mayor Dan Ridenour.
 - **Introductory Speakers & Guests:** Pastor Terrell Jones (Renovation Life Church), Preston Cross (retired banker/Pledge of Allegiance leader), Richard Ivy (Deputy Mayor/HR Director for Muncie Sanitary District), and Mayor Chris Jensen (Noblesville, Indiana).
 - **City Officials & Board Members Recognized:** Various Delaware County elected officials, Muncie City Council members, Muncie Sanitary District board members and employees, the Controller's department, the Building Commissioner's office, the Community Development department, and the legal team.

3. Preliminary & Procedural Business

- **Ceremonial Openings:**
 - [00:01:21](#) Opening invocation delivered by Pastor Terrell Jones, concluding with the Lord's Prayer.
 - [00:05:58](#) Presentation of colors and the Pledge of Allegiance led by Preston Cross.
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4. Substantive Business & Board Action

(The proceedings featured the annual State of the City address delivered by Mayor Dan Ridenour, detailing municipal achievements, capital projects, housing updates, and financial strategies rather than legislative voting items.)

- **Item Identifier & Title:** [00:18:32](#) State of the City Address: "Putting Muncie on the Map"
- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Mayor Dan Ridenour.
- **Deliberation Summary:**
 - **Quality of Life & Public Spaces:** Highlighted downtown gateway improvements, the new \$32 million YMCA facility (with \$2.1 million supported via city-allocated funds and ready grants), the opening of Store Woods Park and Halanan Park, ongoing construction on the Westside Park skate park, and the development of the Till Pond urban fishing park. Noted that Prairie Creek Reservoir serves as a major recreational anchor and home to the long-running 70.3 Triathlon.
 - **Partnerships:** Emphasized strong partnerships with Ball State University (\$195 million village development and Performing Arts Center) and Minnetrista.
 - **Housing Initiatives:** Addressed the historic gap in market-rate apartment construction since 2003. Highlighted the development of Store Estates (sold to DR Horton), McKinley neighborhood townhomes (built by Crew Construction), Washington Square (redevelopment of the former county jail into 15 apartments by the Jennings family), and Right River Lofts. Totaled 489 housing units completed or under construction, contributing to a 900% increase in building permits since 2019.
 - **Infrastructure & Public Safety:** Discussed the city's self-paving initiative utilizing municipal equipment ("Chewy") to dramatically increase paved lane miles. Highlighted growth in public safety staffing, the groundbreaking of Fire Station 6, and a decreasing trend in homicides (13 in 2022, 8 in 2023, 3 in 2024).
 - **Financial Stability:** Noted fiscal prudence through avoiding new Tiff districts, paying cash for developments, and reducing municipal debt by nearly \$2 million since taking office. Highlighted population stabilization, noting a positive increase in the Muncie MSA census numbers after 50 years of decline, bolstered by programs like "Muncie on the Move."
- **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Informational presentation; no formal board vote taken.

5. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

(No open public comment or citizen forum period was held during this address.)

6. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

- **Staff / Board Announcements:**
 - **00:21:48** YMCA ribbon cutting scheduled for the upcoming Saturday with a grand opening on Monday.
 - **00:37:05** Monthly “First Thursday” downtown events highlighted for local businesses and restaurants.
 - **Adjournment:** **01:14:56** The event concluded following closing remarks from Mayor Dan Ridenour.
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